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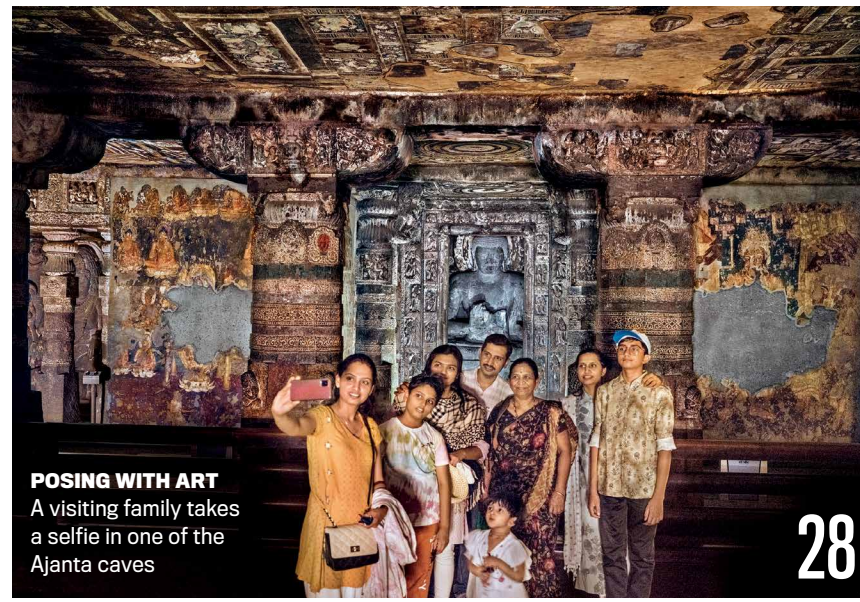
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Photograph by RAGHU RAI

COVER STORY

AJANTA IN PERIL

Poor preservation policies and unbridled tourism have exacted a heavy toll on the ancient cave paintings. How can we save this heritage?

The cover image on the left is from Lady Herringham's version from 1909-11. Having chosen to "fill up the smaller holes" for "the sake of the beauty of the composition", her work is not an exact record of the state of decay. But for colour palette and tone, the historical comparison with Raghu Rai's 2023 frame offers a valid progressive estimation

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